MS Biostatistics Degree Academic Advising and Tracking Form

Department of Biostatistics & Epidemiology

(Requirements Apply to Students Admitted Fall 2025 and Fall 2026)

Name: _____ SPIRE ID: _____

Date of matriculation: _____

Guidance for filling out this form

Summary: The MS Biostatistics degree requires 30 graduate credits beyond the foundational prerequisites.

		Credits
	Foundational Prerequisites	variable
A	Public Health Core	3
B	Biostatistics Core	17
C	Electives (*Biostatistics/Statistics/Epidemiology/Computer Science*)	4
D	Culminating Experience	6
	Total excluding prerequisites =	30

Tracking form

Foundational prerequisites

	Prerequisite	Course Name/Number and Semester/Year Completed	Grade
1	Introduction to regression models, i.e., with PUBHLTH 560 (formerly 490Z)		
2	Probability and inference, i.e., with BIOSTATS 601, OR STATS 515&516		
3	Introduction to R, i.e., with BIOSTATS 530		

A. Public Health Core (3 credits)

	Public Health Core	Semester/Year or (OR waived with replacement Course Name/Number)*	Grade	Credits
1	SPHHS 600 *Great Challenges in PH*			
			Total (3 credits)	

*: Waiver requires a waiver form to be completed and filed with the GPD.

B. Biostatistics Core (17 credits)

	BIOSTATS Core	Semester/Year (OR waived with replacement Course Name/Number)*	Grade	Credits
1	BIOSTATS 531 *Intermediate computing in R*			1
2	BIOSTATS 632 *Advanced computing in R*			1
3	BIOSTATS 680 *Topics in Biostatistics and Data*			3

	Science in Public Health			
4	BIOSTATS 743 *Categorical Data Analysis*			3
5	BIOSTATS 740 *Mixed Models & Longitudinal Data*			3
6	BIOSTATS 748 *Applied Survival Analysis*			3
7	EPI 630 *Principles of Epidemiology*			3
		Total (17 credits)		

*: with advisor approval, courses can be replaced by other courses that fulfill similar learning objectives (i.e., courses offered with a STATS code) or other electives for students who covered the material in prior coursework.

C. Electives (e.g. Biostatistics/Statistics/Epidemiology/Computer Science) (4 credits)
In discussion with the Academic Advisor, students complete 4 additional credits of elective courses, which must be at level 500+.

Elective	Semester/ Year	Grade	Credits
	Total (4 credits)		

D. Required Culminating Experience (6 credits)
Students choose ***one of two options*** for completion of the required culminating experience: 1 (non-thesis) or 2 (thesis).

OPTION 1- Non-thesis
Students choosing option 1 complete BIOSTATS 690E and one additional 3-credit elective course (6 credits, total). The elective courses must be at level 500+. BIOSTATS 690E must be taken at or near the end of the program.

	Course Number and Name	Semester/ Year	Grade	Credits
1	BIOSTATS 690E *Biostatistics in action (culminating experience course)*			3
2				3
		Total (6 credits)		

OPTION 2- Thesis
Students choosing option 2 must complete a 6-credit thesis (BIOSTATS 699). After identifying a thesis project and advisor, students must register for six credits of thesis coursework. A written document conforming to the standards of the graduate school and an oral defense are required for this option.

Thesis Advisor*: _____
**When a MS thesis proposal is submitted, the chair of the committee becomes the student's advisor. This record*

should be transferred if the chair is not the former advisor.

Oral Defense Date: _____ Score (Sat/Unsat): _____

	MS Thesis Credits - BIOSTATS699	Semester/Year	Credits
1			
2			
		Total (Max=6)	

TRANSFER CREDIT, RECORD OF CONTACTS, OTHER INFORMATION

Course Credits Approved for Transfer by Graduate Program Director (12 credit maximum)

Sem/Yr taken	Credits	Course name	Institution

Statute of Limitations Extension: (under extraordinary circumstances)

New SOL Date: _____

Reason for Extension: _____

Faculty requesting: _____

Advisor Contact Record: (At least one contact per semester is recommended)

Advisor	Date	Nature of Contact	Advisor's Signature

Permanent Contact Information:

Street: _____

City/State/Zip _____

Email: _____

Certification of Total of Credits Towards Degree/All Degree Requirements Satisfied

_____ _____ Faculty

Advisor Signature Date